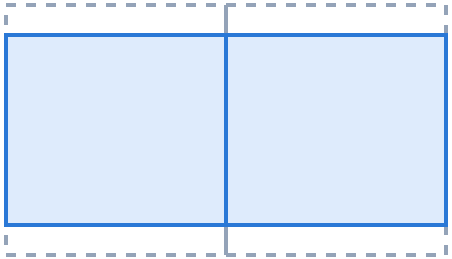
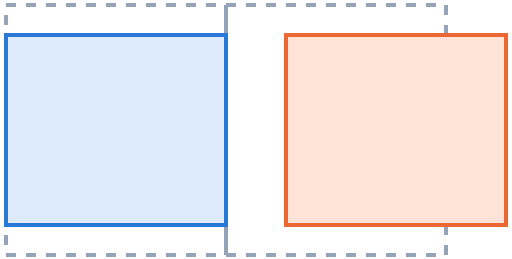
A seam detects a difference between neighbours

A · Neither sheet shifted



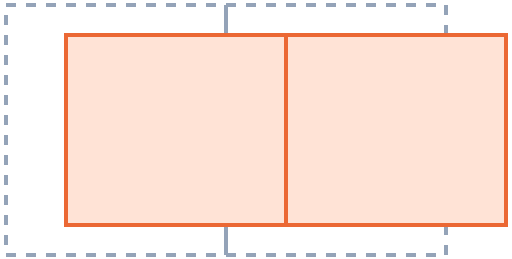
The edges meet.

B · Only one sheet shifted



The gap exposes the fault.

C · Both shifted together



The edges still meet.

Dashed outlines: unshifted cells. Coloured blocks: placed sheets. Schematic, not to scale.

A common shift needs an outside reference. An enforced seam cannot serve as this test.